SNOW AT CHRISTMAS, OR NOT

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the passage carefully. Circle one answer for each multiple choice question, and write full sentences for the others. Look back at the text before you decide.

Snow at Christmas, or Not

165 words

On Christmas cards, snow falls on every rooftop. In real life, most people on Earth have never seen snow on Christmas Day. Whether you get snow depends on where you live. First, think about the two halves of the globe. In December, the top half, the Northern Hemisphere, is tilted away from the sun, so it is winter in Canada, Europe and most of the United States. The bottom half is tilted toward the sun. That means Christmas in Australia, Brazil and South Africa falls in the middle of summer, and families celebrate with beach picnics and barbecues. Second, even in the north, cold is not enough. Snow needs cold air and moisture together. Places near warm oceans, like Florida and southern Spain, stay too mild. Deserts are cold at night but too dry. The surest places for a white Christmas are far north and inland, like Fairbanks, Alaska, or in the mountains, where the air is cold and the storms bring plenty of water.

1. In December, which half of Earth is tilted toward the sun?

the Northern Hemisphere | the Southern Hemisphere | both halves

2. What two things does snow need?

cold air and moisture | wind and mountains | night and clouds

3. In this text, "mild" means WORD

very cold | not very cold | stormy

4. Name one place where Christmas comes in summer.

5. Why do you think deserts rarely get snow, even though they are cold at night? THINK

SNOW AT CHRISTMAS, OR NOT

ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the passage carefully. Circle one answer for each multiple choice question, and write full sentences for the others. Look back at the text before you decide.

Snow at Christmas, or Not

165 words

On Christmas cards, snow falls on every rooftop. In real life, most people on Earth have never seen snow on Christmas Day. Whether you get snow depends on where you live. First, think about the two halves of the globe. In December, the top half, the Northern Hemisphere, is tilted away from the sun, so it is winter in Canada, Europe and most of the United States. The bottom half is tilted toward the sun. That means Christmas in Australia, Brazil and South Africa falls in the middle of summer, and families celebrate with beach picnics and barbecues. Second, even in the north, cold is not enough. Snow needs cold air and moisture together. Places near warm oceans, like Florida and southern Spain, stay too mild. Deserts are cold at night but too dry. The surest places for a white Christmas are far north and inland, like Fairbanks, Alaska, or in the mountains, where the air is cold and the storms bring plenty of water.

1. In December, which half of Earth is tilted toward the sun?

the Northern Hemisphere | **the Southern Hemisphere** | both halves

2. What two things does snow need?

cold air and moisture | wind and mountains | night and clouds

3. In this text, "mild" means WORD

very cold | **not very cold** | stormy

4. Name one place where Christmas comes in summer.

Any one of: Australia, Brazil, South Africa.

5. Why do you think deserts rarely get snow, even though they are cold at night? THINK

They are too dry; snow needs moisture as well as cold, and desert air has very little water in it.

For non-commercial, education use only